

```
sysadmin@localhost:~$ pwd
/home/sysadmin
sysadmin@localhost:~$
```

pwd means **Print Working Directory**.

It tells you **where you currently are** in the Linux filesystem

```
sysadmin@localhost:~$ echo $HOME
/home/sysadmin
sysadmin@localhost:~$
```

This command displays the **path to your home directory**.

```
sysadmin@localhost:~$ cd /
sysadmin@localhost:/$ pwd
/
sysadmin@localhost:/$
```

the `cd` command with a path to a directory to change your current directory

```
sysadmin@localhost:~$ cd /home
```

`cd` command starts with the forward slash `/`, that path is referred to as an “absolute path”. Absolute paths are always complete paths from the root directory to a subdirectory or file.

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls -a
.          .bashrc    .selected_editor  Documents  Pictures  Videos
..         .cache     .sudo_as_admin_successful  Downloads  Public
.bash_logout .profile   Desktop          Music      Templates
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

ls -a lists everything in the current directory, **including hidden files**. In Linux, hidden files are the ones whose names start with a dot, like. a indicates what type of "file" this is.

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls -l /etc/hosts
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 172 Oct  4 10:59 /etc/hosts
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

The following table provides a brief breakdown of what each part of the output of `ls -l` means:

Part	Meaning
-	It is a regular file
rw-	The owner can read and write
r--	The group can only read
r--	Others can only read
1	Number of hard links
root	File owner
root	File group
172	File size = 172 bytes
Oct 4	Last time the file was
10:59	modified
/etc/hosts	The file name/path

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls -R /etc/udev
/etc/udev:
hwdb.d  rules.d  udev.conf

/etc/udev/hwdb.d:

```

The `-R` option stands for "recursive". All of the files in the `/etc/udev` directory will be displayed as well as all of the files in each subdirectory, in this case the `rules.d` subdirectory.

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls -d /etc/s*
/etc/screenrc /etc/services /etc/skel /etc/subgid- /etc/sudoers.d
/etc/securetty /etc/shadow /etc/ssh /etc/subuid /etc/sysctl.conf
/etc/security /etc/shadow- /etc/ssl /etc/subuid- /etc/sysctl.d
/etc/selinux /etc/shells /etc/subgid /etc/sudoers /etc/systemd
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

`-d` option prevents files from subdirectories from being displayed. It should always be used with the `ls` command when you are using file globbing.

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls -d /etc/????
/etc/bind /etc/dpkg /etc/mtab /etc/perl /etc/udev
/etc/dhcp /etc/motd /etc/newt /etc/skel
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

The `?` character can be used to match exactly 1 character in a file name. Execute the following command to display all of the files in the `/etc` directory that are exactly four characters long:

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls -d /etc/[abcd]*
/etc/adduser.conf /etc/binfmt.d /etc/crontab
/etc/alternatives /etc/ca-certificates /etc/dbus-1
/etc/apm /etc/ca-certificates.conf /etc/debconf.conf
/etc/apparmor /etc/calendar /etc/debian_version
/etc/apparmor.d /etc/console-setup /etc/default
/etc/apt /etc/cron.d /etc/deluser.conf
/etc/bash.bashrc /etc/cron.daily /etc/depmod.d
/etc/bash_completion /etc/cron.hourly /etc/dhcp
/etc/bind /etc/cron.monthly /etc/dpkg
/etc/bindresvport.blacklist /etc/cron.weekly
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

By using square brackets `[ ]` you can specify a single character to match from a set of characters.